(a) Both A and R are individually true and R is the correct explanation of A
(b) Both A and R are individually true but R is NOT the correct explanation of A
(c) A is true but R is false
(d) A is false but R is true

Ans. (a) : West flowing rivers Narmada and Tapti do not form delta, because topography of western peninsular India is rocky. Due to this, these rivers do not carry alluvial sediments.

33. Assertion (A) : The thickness of the atmosphere is maximum over the Equator.
Reason (R) : High insolation and strong convection currents occur over the Equator.
(a) Both A and R are individually true and R is the correct explanation of A
(b) Both A and R are individually true but R is NOT the correct explanation of A
(c) A is true but R is false
(d) A is false but R is true

Ans. (b) : The circulation of atmosphere and oceans is fundamentally caused by the fact that the amount of incoming solar radiation varies from a maximum at the equator to a minimum at the poles. More reflection and absorption of incoming radiation takes place in high latitude.
The thickness of the atmosphere is maximum over the equator and high insolation and strong convection currents occur over the Equator.

34. Match List I (Beaches in India) with List II (States) and select the correct answer using the codes given below:

List I		List II
A. Gopnath Beach	1.	Andhra Pradesh
B. Lawsons Bay Beach	2.	Kerala
C. Devbagh Beach	3.	Gujarat
D. Sinquerim Beach	4.	Goa
	5.	Karnataka

	A	B	C	D
(a)	5	4	2	1
(b)	3	1	5	4
(c)	5	1	2	4
(d)	3	4	5	1

Ans. (b) : Beach in India — States
A. Gopinath Beach : Gujarat
B. Lawsons Bay Beach : Andhra Pradesh
C. Devbagh Beach : Karnataka
D. Sinquerim Beach : Goa

WORLD GEOGRAPHY

35. Latvia does not share its borders with which one of the following countries?
(a) Russia (b) Estonia
(c) Lithuania (d) Poland

Ans. (d) : Latvia does not share its borders with Poland. Latvia is bordered by the 4 neighboring nations of Russia (eastwards), Estonia (northwards), Belarus (southeastwards), and Lithuania (southwards).

36. Which one of the following statements is correct?
(a) Cirrus clouds are composed of ice crystals
(b) Cirrus clouds exhibit a flat base and have the appearance of rising domes
(c) Cumulus clouds are white and thin and form delicate patches and give a fibrous and feathery appearance
(d) Cumulus clouds are classified as high clouds

Ans. (a) : The most common form of high-level clouds are thin and often wispy cirrus clouds. Typically found at heights greater than 20,000 feet (6,000 meters), cirrus clouds are composed of ice crystals that originate from the freezing of super cooled water droplets. Cirrus generally occurs in fair weather and points towards the direction of air movement at their elevation.

37. Which one of the following statements is not correct?
(a) Gulfs with narrow fronts and wider rears experience high tides.
(b) Tidal currents take place when a gulf is connected with the open sea by a narrow channel.
(c) Tidal bore occurs when a tide enters the narrow and shallow estuary of a river.
(d) The tidal nature of the mouth of the river Hooghly is of crucial importance to Kolkata as port.

Ans. (a) : Gulfs with narrow fronts and wider rears experience high tides is incorrect. The gulfs with wide fronts and narrow rears experience higher tides. The in and out movement of water into a gulf through channels is called tidal current.

38. Consider the following geological phenomena:
1. Development of a fault
2. Movement along a fault
3. Impact produced by a volcanic eruption
4. Folding of rocks
Which of the above cause earthquakes?
(a) 1, 2 and 3 (b) 2 and 4
(c) 1, 3 and 4 (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Ans. (d) : An earthquake is caused by tectonic plates getting stuck and putting a strain on the ground. The strain becomes so great that rocks give way by breaking and sliding along fault planes. Plate boundaries lock as the plates move past each other, creating frictional stress. Volcanic activity and volcanic eruption is usually triggered by alterations of tectonic plates, resulting in landslides or earthquakes. Volcanic eruptions can be extremely damaging to the environment, particularly because of number of toxic gases possibly present in pyroclastic material. Early in the folding, earthquakes occur on the slipping fault. But as time goes on, the quakes are increasingly caused by the slipping rock layers above and around the fault as the folds buckle under pressure.

39. The great Asian river Mekong does not run through
(a) China (b) Malaysia
(c) Cambodia (d) Laos

Ans. (b) : Mekong river does not flow through Malaysia but runs through China, Laos, Cambodia and Vietnam.

40. Match List I with List II and select the correct answer using the codes given below the lists:

List I (Sea)		List II (Country)
A. Black Sea	1.	Bulgaria
B. Red Sea	2.	China
C. Yellow Sea	3.	Eritrea
D. Caspian Sea	4.	Kazakhstan

	A	B	C	D
(a)	1	4	2	3
(b)	2	3	1	4
(c)	1	3	2	4
(d)	2	4	1	3

Ans. (c) : Black Sea coastal countries - Ukraine, Russia, Georgia, Turkey, Bulgaria. Coastal countries of the Red Sea - Egypt, Sudan, Eritrea, Djibouti, Somalia, Yemen, Saudi Arabia. Yellow Sea - China. Caspian Sea - Russia, Kazakhstan, Turkmenistan, Iran, Azerbaijan. (Source - New School Atlas)

41. Which one of the following does not border Panama?
(a) Costa Rica (b) Pacific Ocean
(c) Colombia (d) Venezuela

Ans. (d) : Venezuela does not border Panama. Panama is a country located in Central America, bordering both the Caribbean Sea and the Pacific Ocean, between Colombia and Costa Rica.

42. Match List I (State/Province/Overseas Territory) with List II (Country) and select the correct answer using the codes given below the lists:

List I		List II
A. British Colombia	1.	USA
B. Bavaria	2.	UK
C. Gibraltar	3.	Canada
D. Rhode Island	4.	Germany
	5.	Denmark

	A	B	C	D
(a)	1	2	5	3
(b)	3	4	2	1
(c)	1	4	2	3
(d)	3	2	5	1

Ans. (b) : British Colombia is western most provinces of Canada, Bavaria is a state of Germany. Gibraltar is the overseas territory of UK and Rhoda Island is the smallest state in USA.

INDIAN CONSTITUTION & POLITY

43. Which one of the following statements is not correct?
(a) In Lok Sabha, a no-confidence motion has to set out the grounds on which it is based
(b) In the case of a no-confidence motion in Lok Sabha, no conditions of admissibility have been laid down in the Rules
(c) A motion of no-confidence once admitted, has to be taken up within ten days of the leave being granted
(d) Rajya Sabha is not empowered to entertain a motion of no-confidence

Ans. (a) : If any member of the House feels that the government does not have majority then he/she can move a no confidence motion. The member need not give a reason for moving no confidence motion. As per rule 198 of the Rules of Procedure and Conduct of Lok Sabha a minimum of 50 members have to accept the motion and accordingly the speaker will announce the date for discussion for the motion. The allotted date has to be within 10 days from the day motion is accepted.

44. With reference to Indian Public Finance, consider the following statements:
1. **Disbursements from Public Accounts of India are subject to the Vote of Parliament.**
2. **The Indian Constitution provides for the establishment of a Consolidated Fund, a Public Account and a Contingency Fund for each State.**
3. **Appropriations and disbursements under the Railway Budget are subject to the same form of parliamentary control as other appropriations and disbursements.**
Which of the statements given above are correct?
(a) 1 and 2 (b) 2 and 3
(c) 1 and 3 (d) 1, 2 and 3